was a special invitee to that meeting. He later told the media that the Prime Minister should not have met Prabhakaran in the first place. Apparently, Natwar Singh had asked Rajiv Gandhi later if he had got anything in writing from the LTTE chief. The PM had apparently got irritated and said that the rebel leader had given him his word. Natwar Singh had to say that Prabhakaran's word, to him, meant nothing as he had done it more than once. He later told Anirudhya that the LTTE boss should have been asked to give his 'consent in writing' as 'he would double-cross us when it suited him'.

Two years later, in July 1987, Prabhakaran visited Delhi again in connection with the finalization of the Indo-Sri Lanka Accord. He was again staying at the Ashoka Hotel, although he felt he was put under house arrest. Prabhakaran, in a telephone conversation with Balasingham, was heard saying that he would teach Rajiv Gandhi a lesson if they let him go. He was of the view that New Delhi would arrest him during that visit. Six years later, Prabhakaran used a human bomb to kill his former host at a political rally. The unexpected discovery of the telephone tapping was good for proving the LTTE's motive behind killing Rajiv Gandhi but was of no help when it came to tracking Sivarasan, which was a priority at that time.

Stories to divert the attention of the SIT were continuously being planted in the media, both national and foreign. Even before the phone-tapping controversy—when the Indian security agencies had tapped Prabhakaran's phone when he was staying at the Ashoka hotel—had settled down, a report from the R&AW surfaced. It highlighted that the head of R&AW's counter-terrorism division, B. Raman, had sent a secret assessment to then Cabinet Secretary Vinod Pandey on the 'likely threat' to then Opposition leader Rajiv Gandhi. The veteran sleuth had stated that 'there was a greater threat to the security of Rajiv Gandhi as the leader of the Opposition than to the security of V.P. Singh as the Prime Minister'. The report also stated that the main threats to Rajiv Gandhi were Khalistani terrorists in the north and the Sri Lankan Tamil terrorist organizations in the south. The report made a strong case for the continuation of the security cover of the SPG to Rajiv.